

D565

Cultural Awareness and Ethics

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A hiring manager at a regional bank who volunteers at a food pantry says she values diversity and supports equal opportunity. A review of her last 50 interviews shows she rated candidates with foreign-sounding names lower even when résumés were identical. The bank recently updated its logo. What best explains the gap?

- A. Implicit bias shaping her ratings despite her sincere values.
- B. No bias is possible, since she openly supports diversity.
- C. Explicit bias that she is hiding.
- D. Her volunteer work has made her more critical of candidates.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A person openly states that one ethnic group is less trustworthy and says he avoids hiring its members. What type of bias is this?

- A. Confirmation bias.
- B. Implicit bias.
- C. A stereotype only, with no bias involved.
- D. Explicit bias.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

At a tech startup with a rooftop garden, a team lead believes older workers are slow to learn software. Because of that belief, he assigns every new-system training slot to employees under 35. The company had a record quarter. Which term best describes his assignment decision?

- A. Stereotype.
- B. Discrimination.
- C. Prejudice.
- D. Not bias, since the company is succeeding.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which statement is an example of prejudice rather than a stereotype or discrimination?

- A.** “I just feel uneasy and irritated whenever people from that neighborhood come in.”
- B.** Refusing to rent to applicants from that neighborhood.
- C.** Any comment that mentions a neighborhood.
- D.** “People from that neighborhood are all bad with money.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A supervisor who commutes by train believes one employee is careless. At review time she remembers the two reports he filed late, but not the eleven he filed early. Her office overlooks a river. What is most likely happening?

- A.** Accurate judgment, since two late reports prove carelessness.
- B.** Implicit bias based on group membership.
- C.** Confirmation bias.
- D.** Recency effect from the morning train ride.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

At a hospital orientation held in a newly renovated auditorium, a staff member tells a U.S.-born Asian American colleague, “Your English is so good!” The colleague looks uncomfortable. The staff member later says, “I meant it as a compliment.” Lunch was catered by a local deli. What is the best way to understand the exchange?

- A.** It was overt discrimination that requires termination.
- B.** Compliments can never be offensive.
- C.** It was a microaggression; the impact matters, and the staff member should listen and acknowledge it.
- D.** It was not harmful, because the intent was kind.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A physical therapist who completed a weekend workshop on the cultural customs of a local immigrant community is about to treat a patient from that community. The clinic has a new scheduling system. Which approach best reflects cultural humility?

- A. Apply the workshop's list of customs to plan the session.
- B. Avoid any mention of culture to keep things neutral.
- C. Consider cultural learning complete, since the workshop is finished.
- D. Ask the patient what matters to them about their care and how they prefer to be treated.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

An adult patient who is a retired firefighter and has decision-making capacity refuses a recommended surgery after hearing the risks and benefits. His daughter, who lives out of state, wants the team to proceed anyway. Honoring his refusal reflects which principle?

- A. Beneficence.
- B. Autonomy.
- C. Nonmaleficence, because surgery always causes harm.
- D. Justice.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A clinic creates a transparent system so that scarce specialist appointments are given out by medical need rather than by who calls first. Which ethical principle is it applying?

- A. Autonomy.
- B. Nonmaleficence.
- C. Beneficence.
- D. Justice.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

An exchange student who plays in a jazz band notices that families in her host country eat the main meal at 3 p.m. She tells friends at home the custom is “backward” because “normal people eat dinner at night.” Her host city has a famous cathedral. Which concept does her reaction illustrate?

- A. Culture shock.
- B. Ethnocentrism.
- C. Cultural humility.
- D. Cultural relativism.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which statement best reflects cultural relativism?

- A. “Their way is wrong because it isn’t how we do it.”
- B. “All cultures are the same underneath.”
- C. “To understand why they share meals this way, I need to learn what the practice means in their community.”
- D. “Because it is cultural, no practice can ever be questioned for any reason.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An urgent-care clinic with new waiting-room furniture finds that, on busy evenings, patients from certain groups wait longer for pain medication. Staff all completed a one-hour bias awareness module last year. Which change is most likely to reduce the disparity?

- A. Adopt a standard pain-assessment protocol with clear criteria for every patient.
- B. Ask staff to rely more on their gut feeling to move faster.
- C. Replace the waiting-room furniture to improve patient comfort.
- D. Rely on last year’s awareness module, since staff already know about bias.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A hiring manager at a regional bank ~~who volunteers at a food pantry~~ says she values diversity and supports equal opportunity. A review of her last 50 interviews shows she rated candidates with foreign-sounding names lower even when résumés were identical. ~~The bank recently updated its logo.~~ What best explains the gap?

Target word: type of bias **Decides:** Stated fair values but different behavior.

A	Correct	Automatic associations can drive behavior that contradicts conscious beliefs.
B	Absolute language	Sincere values do not rule out implicit bias.
C	Confusion set	Nothing suggests she consciously endorses the bias; the gap fits implicit bias.
D	Camouflage	The volunteer detail does not explain the rating pattern.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

A person openly states that one ethnic group is less trustworthy and says he avoids hiring its members. What type of bias is this?

Target word: classify a conscious, stated bias — reverse direction **Decides:** The attitude is conscious and endorsed.

A	Adjacent category	A way of processing evidence, not the attitude itself.
B	Inverted operation	Implicit bias operates outside awareness; this is openly endorsed.
C	Dropped element	Drops the stated avoidance, which is discriminatory intent based on the attitude.
D	Correct	He is aware of and states the attitude.

3. Answer B Concept 2

At a tech startup ~~with a rooftop garden~~, a team lead believes older workers are slow to learn software. Because of that belief, he assigns every new-system training slot to employees under 35. ~~The company had a record quarter.~~ Which term best describes his assignment decision?

Target word: belief vs. feeling vs. action **Decides:** The decision is unequal treatment—an action.

A	Confusion set	His belief is the stereotype; the assignment is what the question asks about.
B	Correct	Treating people differently based on group membership is the behavioral component.
C	Adjacent category	Prejudice is the feeling toward a group, not the act.
D	Camouflage	Company performance does not make unequal treatment fair.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

Which statement is an example of prejudice rather than a stereotype or discrimination?

Target word: identify the affective component **Decides:** Prejudice is a feeling.

A	Correct	A negative emotion toward a group is prejudice.
B	Inverted operation	An action—discrimination.
C	Absolute language	Mentioning a place is not prejudice.
D	Confusion set	A generalized belief—stereotype.

5. Answer C Concept 3

A supervisor ~~who commutes by train~~ believes one employee is careless. At review time she remembers the two reports he filed late, but not the eleven he filed early. ~~Her office overlooks a river.~~ What is most likely happening?

Target word: bias in weighing evidence **Decides:** She recalls only what fits her prior belief.

A	Dropped element	Drops the eleven early reports.
B	Adjacent category	No group identity is involved; this is about a belief about one person.
C	Correct	Evidence that fits the belief is remembered; contradicting evidence is discounted.
D	Camouflage	The commute is irrelevant to how she weighs evidence.

6. Answer C Concept 4

At a hospital orientation ~~held in a newly renovated auditorium~~, a staff member tells a U.S.-born Asian American colleague, "Your English is so good!" The colleague looks uncomfortable. The staff member later says, "I meant it as a compliment." ~~Lunch was catered by a local deli.~~ What is the best way to understand the exchange?

Target word: intent vs. impact **Decides:** The comment implied the colleague is a foreigner despite kind intent.

A	Adjacent category	A microaggression is subtler than overt discrimination; the response is usually learning and repair.
B	Absolute language	A compliment can carry a demeaning assumption.
C	Correct	Good intent does not erase a message of "you don't belong here."
D	Inverted operation	Puts intent over impact.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A physical therapist who completed a weekend workshop on the cultural customs of a local immigrant community is about to treat a patient from that community. ~~The clinic has a new scheduling system.~~ Which approach best reflects cultural humility?

Target word: humility vs. competence **Decides:** Treating the patient as the expert on their own preferences.

A	Confusion set	That is a checklist approach; individuals vary within any group.
B	Inverted operation	Ignoring culture is not humility; it skips learning the patient's perspective.
C	Absolute language	Humility is lifelong, not a completed course.
D	Correct	Humility centers the individual's perspective and ongoing learning.

8. Answer B Concept 6

An adult patient ~~who is a retired firefighter~~ and has decision-making capacity refuses a recommended surgery after hearing the risks and benefits. His daughter, ~~who lives out of state~~, wants the team to proceed anyway. Honoring his refusal reflects which principle?

Target word: named principle **Decides:** A capable adult's right to decide.

A	Confusion set	Beneficence would push toward the surgery the team thinks is good for him.
B	Correct	Respecting a capable person's informed choice.
C	Absolute language	Surgery is not always harmful; the case turns on his choice.
D	Adjacent category	Justice concerns fair distribution, not individual choice.

9. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

A clinic creates a transparent system so that scarce specialist appointments are given out by medical need rather than by who calls first. Which ethical principle is it applying?

Target word: principle from an action — reverse direction **Decides:** Fair distribution of a scarce resource.

A	Adjacent category	Autonomy is about individual choice, not allocation.
B	Inverted operation	Avoiding harm is a different principle from distributing fairly.
C	Confusion set	Doing good is involved, but the defining feature is fair distribution.
D	Correct	Justice addresses fair allocation of benefits and burdens.

10. Answer B Concept 7

An exchange student ~~who plays in a jazz band~~ notices that families in her host country eat the main meal at 3 p.m. She tells friends at home the custom is “backward” because “normal people eat dinner at night.” ~~Her host city has a famous cathedral.~~ Which concept does her reaction illustrate?

Target word: judgment frame **Decides:** Judging another culture by her own culture’s standard.

A	Adjacent category	Culture shock is disorientation in a new culture; the question asks about judging it.
B	Correct	Her own culture is treated as the measure of “normal.”
C	Confusion set	Humility involves self-reflection and curiosity, the opposite of her reaction.
D	Inverted operation	Relativism would try to understand the meal time in its context.

11. Answer C Concept 7 · transfer

Which statement best reflects cultural relativism?

Target word: identify relativism — reverse direction **Decides:** Understanding a practice within its own context.

A	Inverted operation	That is ethnocentrism.
B	Dropped element	Drops the point that context gives practices different meanings.
C	Correct	Seeks meaning within the culture’s own context.
D	Absolute language	Relativism is a tool for understanding, not a ban on ethical judgment.

12. Answer A Concept 8

An urgent-care clinic ~~with new waiting room furniture~~ finds that, on busy evenings, patients from certain groups wait longer for pain medication. Staff all completed a one-hour bias awareness module last year. Which change is most likely to reduce the disparity?

Target word: effective bias-reduction strategy **Decides:** Bias grows under time pressure and vague criteria.

A	Correct	Structured criteria limit the room for bias during rushed decisions.
B	Inverted operation	Fast, intuitive judgment is where implicit bias shows up most.
C	Camouflage	Furniture does not change clinical decision-making.
D	Absolute language	One-time awareness training alone rarely changes behavior.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	7	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Explicit vs. implicit bias	Explicit bias is a conscious, endorsed attitude; implicit bias is an automatic association that can shape behavior even in people who sincerely reject the stereotype.	Believing that people who hold fair values cannot act on bias.	A person who states egalitarian beliefs but behaves differently toward groups.
2	Stereotype, prejudice, discrimination	A stereotype is a belief about a group (cognitive), prejudice is a feeling toward a group (affective), and discrimination is unequal treatment (behavioral).	Using the three words interchangeably.	Is it a thought, a feeling, or an action?
3	Confirmation bias	People notice, recall, and weigh information that confirms what they already believe and discount evidence against it.	Thinking more exposure to information always corrects bias.	Remembering the cases that fit a belief and forgetting those that don't.
4	Microaggressions: impact over intent	A microaggression is a brief, often unintentional comment or action that communicates a demeaning message to a marginalized group member; the impact matters even when the intent was kind, and the best response is to listen, acknowledge, and adjust.	Defending good intentions as proof no harm occurred.	A “compliment” that implies a person is an exception to their group or an outsider.
5	Cultural humility vs. cultural competence	Cultural humility is a lifelong practice of self-reflection, recognizing power imbalances, and treating the other person as the expert on their own culture; competence alone can become a checklist of group facts.	Believing cultural learning is complete once you have studied a group's customs.	Asking the person about their preferences vs. assuming from a group profile.
6	Core ethical principles	Autonomy = respecting a person's right to decide; beneficence = acting for their good; nonmaleficence = avoiding harm; justice = fair distribution of benefits and burdens.	Mislabeling a respect-for-choice situation as beneficence.	Whose choice, whose good, whose harm, or whose fair share.
7	Ethnocentrism vs. cultural relativism	Ethnocentrism judges other cultures by one's own culture's standards; cultural relativism seeks to understand practices within their own cultural context.	Assuming cultural relativism means no practice can ever be questioned on ethical grounds.	Calling another culture's custom “strange” or “wrong” by default.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Strategies that reduce biased decisions	Bias shows up most under time pressure, fatigue, and vague criteria; slowing down, using structured criteria, individuating (seeing the specific person), and perspective-taking reduce it more than awareness alone.	Believing a one-time training or good intentions remove bias.	Rushed, subjective decisions such as quick triage or unstructured interviews.

Course scope (public description): Cultural Awareness and Ethics provides students with the understanding of what it means to have personal, explicit and implicit cultural biases and how these can affect interpersonal interactions. The course will explore strategies for responding to personal biases and for promoting cultural awareness and ethical actions. Through critical readings, videos, and interactive activities, the student will gain knowledge in these essential subjects. There are no prerequisites for this course.